

# Visa.

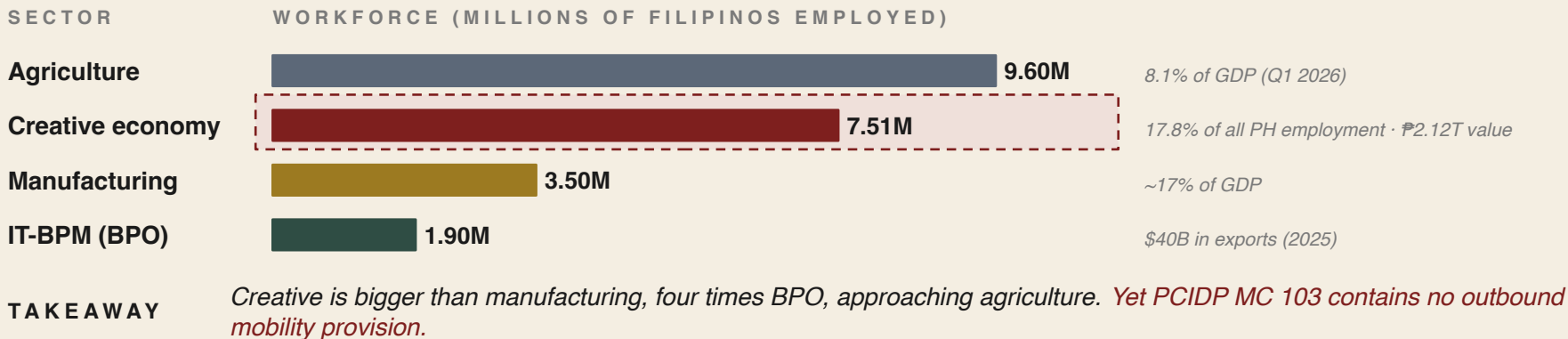
A founder's case for adding outbound mobility to the Philippine Creative Industries framework.

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|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>BASIS</b>    | PSA Creative Economy data · RA 11904 / PCIDP MC 103 · a decade of personal advocacy |
| <b>ASK</b>      | An IRR amendment, a Senate hearing, or a Creative Workers Mobility Act              |
| <b>SCALE</b>    | ₱2.12T economy · 7.51M workers · 30% U.S. visa denial rate                          |
| <b>AUDIENCE</b> | Sen. Paolo Benigno “Bam” Aquino IV · for policy review and partnership              |

# Creative is the second-largest sector by workforce in the country.

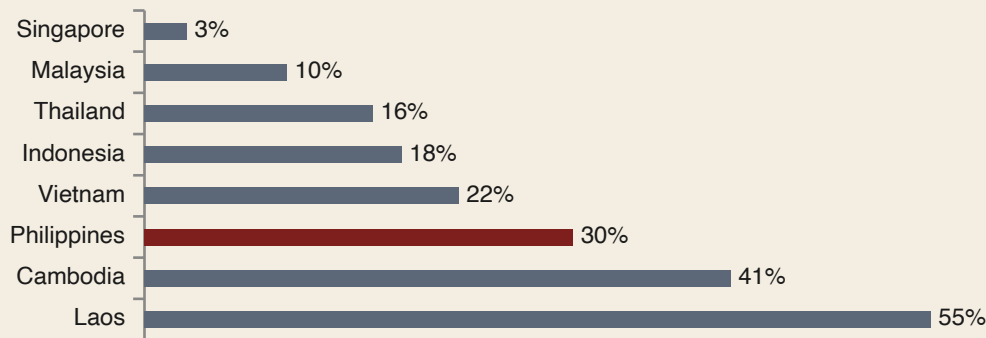
7.51 million Filipinos work in creative industries — already four times the BPO workforce, approaching agriculture in scale. ₱2.12T value, comparable to OFW remittances.



Source. PSA Creative Economy 2025 via BusinessWorld; IBPAP 2025; BSP 2025; PSA Agriculture Q1 2026.

# Filipinos face the third-highest U.S. tourist-visa denial rate in Southeast Asia.

*U.S. B-visa refusal rates by country of nationality, fiscal year 2024. Touring artists apply across multiple jurisdictions simultaneously — one delay drops a city.*



## THE ASYMMETRY

*U.S., Korean, and Japanese artists enter the Philippines visa-free.*

Filipino artists going the other way: 3-month process, \$185 fee, embassy interview, provincial travel — for a 30% chance of refusal.

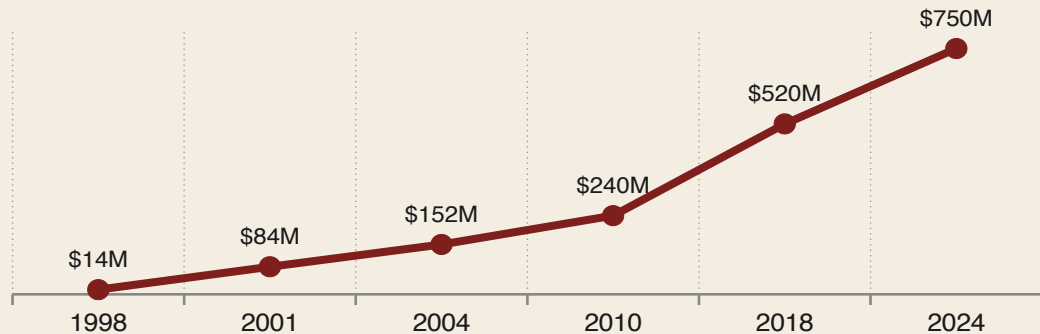
## TAKEAWAY

*U.S., Korean, and Japanese acts enter PH visa-free. Filipino artists face a 30% denial rate going the other way. **Reciprocity isn't a foreign-policy problem — it's an asymmetry we let stand.***

Source. U.S. Department of State FY24 visa refusal rates; SchengenVisaInfo Philippines 2023.

# Korea's culture spend rose sixfold in three years — then Hallyu broke globally.

South Korean government spending on cultural industries, USD millions. The Philippines is already at Korea's current GDP share — without comparable state investment.



## PHILIPPINES TODAY (2025)

# 7.6%

of GDP from creative industries — already at Korea's current share, without comparable state investment.

### TAKEAWAY

We're already post-Hallyu in size. **Pre-Hallyu in policy.** The question is whether we keep doing the next chapter the hard way.

Source. Atlantic Council; Korea Herald (KOCCA, 2024 exports); PSA Creative Economy 2025.

# *Filipino artists put their visa frustration on a global chart.*

SB19 — “VISA” · released 20 February 2026 · debuted #6 on the U.S. World Digital Song Sales chart · 3 months in flight globally.

*“Filipino **artists, athletes, and professionals** all face the same challenges with visa processes.”*

— SB19, on releasing “VISA”

**50+**

countries streaming daily — a campaign already in flight

**3 months**

since release — the Overton window has moved publicly

**#6**

U.S. World Digital Song Sales debut — real audience weight

Source. *Inquirer Entertainment; Lifestyle Inquirer; GMA; Wikipedia.*

## *A decade ago, before SB19, the same visa wall already stood.*

*A personal note before the policy ask.*

### **This advocacy isn't new for me.**

In 2014 I was a BPO call center agent. I was also part of a Filipino dance cover group called **Se-Eon** with Stell, winning regional competitions on our own savings.

That same year, Stell and I met BTS backstage — during their early “Danger” era, before they became the biggest band in the world.

They had state-backed scaffolding when they crossed borders. Filipino artists had nothing. ***We were on our own.***

*Even after proving ourselves in seven competitions, the visa wall was the same then as it is today.*

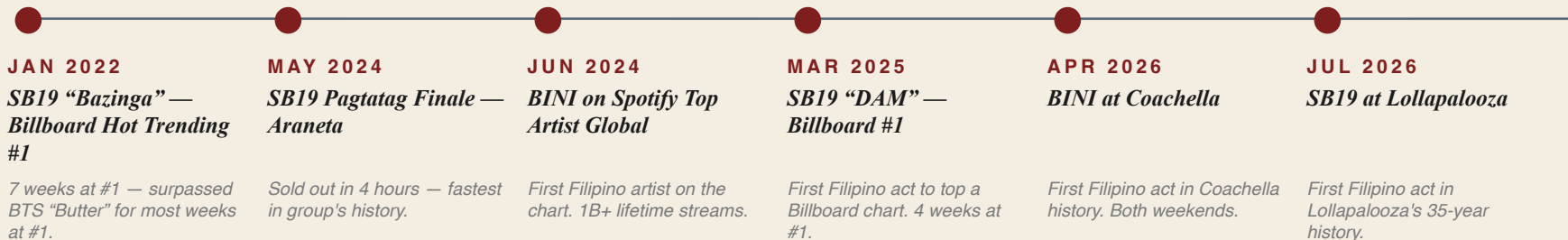
### **TAKEAWAY**

*The song “VISA” is one expression of that thinking. ***This meeting is another.****

*Source. GMA News Online; Wikipedia (Josh Cullen, musician); Radar.ph.*

# Six Filipino firsts on global stages. None state-supported.

Each entry below is the first time any Filipino act achieved the listed milestone. None received dedicated state-export support.



**TAKEAWAY** \$88M PH recorded-music market. \$1.8B Korea music exports (20x). **PCIDP MC 103 has no music-export budget line.**

Source. Rolling Stone; GMA; Billboard PH; Koreaboo; Newsbytes PH / PARI; Korea Herald.

# *The framework is already signed. The mobility chapter is missing.*

Three current Marcos-administration instruments already cover creative-industry development. None of them addresses outbound mobility.

2022

## *RA 11904*

*Philippine Creative Industries Development Act*

Established creative industries as a national priority. DTI lead agency. Created the Creative Industries Development Council.

### TAKEAWAY

*The President signed the framework. The agencies have the mandate. **The 10-year clock is already running.***

*Source. LawPhil (RA 11904); DFA via PNA; PCO; Supreme Court E-Library (MC 103).*

DEC 2024

## *DFA Soft Power Roadmap*

*Released by Sec. Manalo*

Cultural diplomacy as a pillar of Bagong Pilipinas. The Office of Cultural Diplomacy already issues endorsement letters.

OCT 2025

## *PCIDP MC No. 103*

*Signed by Exec. Sec. Bersamin*

10-year creative-economy implementation plan. Already commits to “increase global market presence for Filipino content.”

## *Korea built five mobility instruments. PH has none.*

*Side-by-side: the export-support tools Korea built between 1998–2010, and their status in the Philippines today.*

| INSTRUMENT                               | KOREA                              | PHILIPPINES                |
|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| Dedicated content-export agency          | KOCCA (2009)                       | —                          |
| State-backed bilateral cultural treaties | 20+ co-production agreements       | —                          |
| DFA endorsement protocol for artists     | Through MOFA cultural attachés     | Ad hoc, request-by-request |
| Visa fast-track / talent-mobility track  | E-6 reciprocity, MOFA support      | —                          |
| Standalone music-export budget           | KRW 1 trillion KOCCA budget (2024) | Not in PCIDP MC 103        |

**TAKEAWAY**     *Four of five instruments don't exist on the PH side. **The mobility pillar belongs in the PCIDP IRR update.***

*Source. KOCCA; Korean Foundation for Cultural Exchange; PCIDP MC 103 (SC E-Library); RA 11904.*

# Three ways to add a mobility pillar to the PCIDP.

*Graded by ambition and timeline. The senator picks what fits.*

## OPTION A

### *Convene a Senate hearing.*

LOWEST-COST MOVE

- Committee on Culture & the Arts
- Calls DFA, DTI, NCCA to the table
- Public, builds record, generates momentum

**30 – 60 days · minimal cost**

## OPTION B

### *Push the IRR amendment.*

SURGICAL OPTION

- Direct request to DTI + NCCA
- Adds Mobility Pillar to PCIDP IRR
- We provide draft IRR language

**6 – 12 months · no new appropriation**

## OPTION C

### *File the bill.*

LEGACY MOVE — YOU AS PRINCIPAL AUTHOR

- Creative Workers Mobility Act
- Codifies the Mobility Pillar in statute
- Permanent inter-agency body

**1 – 2 years · carries the next decade**

*We'd want majority cover. **We trust your judgment on the co-author.***

*You already solved this for the athletes. Filipino artists are asking for the same.*

*“We have tremendous talent and potential to conquer the global gaming arena, which is why we worked with the eSports community to organize PeSPA **and to resolve visa issues when they compete abroad.**”*

— Sen. Bam Aquino, on PeSPA and Filipino esports

You organized PeSPA. You authored Senate Resolution 276. The athletes you championed already have the playbook **you built**.  
The creative economy is already **four times the BPO workforce**.

*You've already done it for the athletes. **We came to you because nobody else has built this lane.***

Source. [bamaquino.com](http://bamaquino.com) (PeSPA / esports statements); Sunstar Manila (SR 276).